exercise for lead time to make sure the statistics represent the true work of the team.

Using this technique with the data shown, managers can get a good idea of the big picture and drill into trends when they become apparent. Managers care about individuals as well as data across teams. Ultimately managers also care about how their team's performance affects strategic goals because that's what they're responsible for showing to the higher levels of leadership in their organization.

9.1.3. What executives care about

The next few levels up the organization chart can change team composition or organization structure, budgets, and strategies. Leadership teams care how things are working currently, but they're usually more interested in the big picture and how that affects the well-being of the company as a whole. If teams are hitting their goals and the organization is successful, you may not even have to worry about rolling reports up to this level. When I have to address senior leadership, I make sure that I can demonstrate the information they need as quickly and efficiently as possible. Interestingly enough, communication to leadership often happens through presentations instead of through dashboards and ad hoc metrics. The size of your organization and how hands-on your leadership team is will determine the best way to communicate data to them. Normally they'll be most interested in data around strategic objectives. If your leadership team sets a strategic direction to better engage customers by releasing code more frequently through a DevOps model, you should publish the release frequency over time so they can see the progress you're making on the strategy.

The business metrics we talked about in chapter 6 are great candidates for data that executives would care about. If you created a metric that determined business success criteria of a product, then that metric over time is definitely going to be something the people sponsoring your team will care about. If there are several development teams in your organization and each has its own set of business success criteria metrics, the aggregation of all these metrics would produce a great example of a dashboard or report that leadership would care about.